DREAMCATCHER

A science fiction story

Prologue

The sound of a burning hearth was the first thing Ludwig heard. It was humming quietly and sometimes making a loud cracking noise, as if the flames were sharp teeth biting through the logs, chewing them with vigour and satisfaction. It made Ludwig hungry too, as he sat in an old armchair curled under a blanket.

It was a cold winter night in Norway, the winds howling outside the house walls, and Ludwig knew that going to the kitchen to get some food would drain all the warmth out of him.

Chapter 1